

3.2

Job interview

Business Builder
Teacher Resource Series

Worksheet

A Work with a partner. Discuss the following 'tips' for a successful interview. Do you agree with all of them? Add one more of your own.

- 1 Before the interview, ask a friend/colleague to ask you typical questions. In particular, practise talking about your strong points using concrete examples from your current job.
- 2 Before the interview, write to the people who will give you references. Tell them to expect a call and give them a recent copy of your CV/Resume.
- 3 Arrive 30 minutes early on site and 10 minutes early for the interview. Use the time to walk in the fresh air. When greeting the interviewer, smile, make eye contact and shake hands firmly.
- 4 Your clothes, shoes and hair need to be tidy and above your normal standard.
- 5 Keep your answers short, simple and relevant – as you would in other business situations. Interviews are a dialogue so don't talk more than 60–70% of the time. If the interviewer wants more information, let him/her ask for it.
- 6 Occasionally take the initiative and ask questions to show you are interested.
- 7 Be enthusiastic and positive. Never contradict, argue or interrupt. Never criticize previous employers during the interview.
- 8 Don't be submissive. Treat the interviewer with respect, but as an equal.
- 9 Don't ask questions about the salary. If possible, wait for the interviewer to mention it. Ask for higher than you expect. If in doubt, ask for your current salary plus 15%.
- 10 Immediately after the interview make notes: write down names, details about the organization, and especially company 'buzzwords'. If called for a second interview, make sure you use these.
- 11 Consider writing a short follow-up letter, particularly after informal interviews where there was no clear job being advertised. Express your pleasure in meeting everyone (list them by name), comment on one part of the meeting (something that emphasizes your qualifications), mention again the benefits you can bring to the company and why you would like to work there (include company buzzwords).

12 _____

B Work in groups of two/three. Have a formal mini-interview.

Interviewee Before you start, give your CV/Resume to your interviewer/s to look through.

Interviewer/s Ask questions, listen carefully, ask follow-up questions.